

PHISHING ALERT INVESTIGATION

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) & Investigation Checklist

Author: Akorede Michael Alokun | June 2026

1. Incident Information

Incident ID	INC-2026-____
Alert Source	Email Gateway / SIEM / User Report
Date & Time Detected	
Analyst Name	Akorede Michael Alokun
Severity (Initial)	P1 / P2 / P3 / P4
Ticket Status	Open / In Progress / Closed

2. Step-by-Step Investigation Checklist

Work through each phase in order. Check the box when the step is complete. Note findings in the right column.

PHASE 1 — INITIAL TRIAGE (Target: < 10 minutes)		
☐	Retrieve the suspicious email from the security mailbox or SIEM alert	Source: _____
☐	Identify sender email address and display name	Sender: _____
☐	Check if sender domain spoofs a legitimate organization	Legitimate domain: _____
☐	Record email subject line and timestamp	Subject: _____
☐	Identify all recipients — how many received this email?	Count: _____
☐	Assign initial severity based on impact scope	Severity: _____
PHASE 2 — EMAIL HEADER ANALYSIS		
☐	Extract full email headers (X-Originating-IP, Received-From)	Tool: Email client / Mimecast
☐	Check SPF result — Pass / Fail / Softfail?	Result: _____

☐	Check DKIM signature — Valid / Invalid?	Result: _____
☐	Check DMARC policy — Pass / Fail / None?	Result: _____
☐	Identify originating IP — look up in VirusTotal / AbuseIPDB	IP: _____
☐	Check if IP is on any threat intel blacklist	Blacklisted: Y / N
PHASE 3 — LINK & ATTACHMENT ANALYSIS		
☐	Extract all URLs from email body (do NOT click directly)	URL count: _____
☐	Submit URLs to VirusTotal for reputation scan	VT Score: _____
☐	Detonate URL in Any.run sandbox — observe behavior	Verdict: _____
☐	Check if URL redirects to credential harvesting page	Harvest page: Y / N
☐	If attachment present — extract file hash (MD5/SHA256)	Hash: _____
☐	Submit file hash to VirusTotal	Detections: _____
☐	Detonate attachment in Any.run sandbox	Behavior: _____
☐	Note any C2 callbacks observed in sandbox (IP, domain, port)	C2: _____
PHASE 4 — VICTIM IMPACT ASSESSMENT		
☐	Identify if any user clicked the malicious link (proxy/web logs)	User: _____
☐	Identify if any user opened the malicious attachment (EDR logs)	User: _____
☐	Check if credentials were submitted on phishing page	Compromised: Y / N
☐	Review user workstation for signs of malware execution (EDR)	Artifacts: _____
☐	Search SIEM for lateral movement from affected workstation	Lateral: Y / N
☐	Determine business impact: data accessed, systems affected	Impact: _____
PHASE 5 — CONTAINMENT & RESPONSE		
☐	Delete phishing email from all recipient mailboxes (email gateway)	Deleted: Y / N
☐	Block sender domain at email gateway	Blocked: Y / N
☐	Block malicious URL/IP at web proxy and firewall	Rule ID: _____
☐	Block malicious file hash in EDR / AV platform	Blocked: Y / N
☐	If compromise confirmed — isolate affected host from network	Hostname: _____

☐	Reset password for any compromised user accounts	Users reset: _____
☐	Revoke active sessions / OAuth tokens for compromised accounts	Sessions cleared: Y / N
☐	Enable enhanced monitoring on affected user and host (30 days)	Watchlist added: Y / N
PHASE 6 — DOCUMENTATION & CLOSURE		
☐	Document all IOCs: IPs, domains, hashes, email addresses	IOC list attached: Y / N
☐	Map TTPs to MITRE ATT&CK framework	Techniques: _____
☐	Write incident timeline from detection to closure	Report attached: Y / N
☐	Update SIEM detection rules to catch similar future attacks	Rule updated: Y / N
☐	Share IOCs with threat intel team / ISAC if applicable	Shared: Y / N
☐	Close incident ticket and conduct lessons learned	Closure date: _____

3. IOC Collection Log

IOC Type	Value	Source	Verdict
IP Address			
Domain / URL			
File Hash (SHA256)			
Email Address			
File Name			

4. MITRE ATT&CK TTP Mapping

Tactic	Technique	ID	Evidence
Initial Access			
Execution			
Credential Access			
Command & Control			
Exfiltration			